



# Individual Instructor Report Spring 2025 Version A for STA 235 - DATA SCI FOR BUSN APPLCTNS-WB (05570) (Henrique Bolfarine)

Project Title: **Course Evaluations Spring 2025**

Courses Audience: **55**

Responses Received: **49**

Response Ratio: **89.1%**

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## Report Comments

### Guide to the Interpretation of Course Evaluations at UT Austin

The goal of course evaluation process at UT Austin is to drive teaching excellence and to support continuous improvement in teaching and learning experiences. The two sets of scales used for core evaluation questions and the associated weights are:

Strongly Agree (5)  
Agree (4)  
Neutral (3)  
Disagree (2)  
Strongly Disagree (1)

Excellent (5)  
Very Good (4)  
Satisfactory (3)  
Unsatisfactory (2)  
Very Unsatisfactory (1)

The Mean is calculated by adding all of the weights for a single question and dividing by the number of respondents. The course workload question is not averaged.

The number of students (e.g. respondents) marking each option is reported for each of the items. These frequency distributions provide information about the level of student ratings and the spread and shape of the class distribution of responses. The distributions thus provide a picture of student perception of a course.

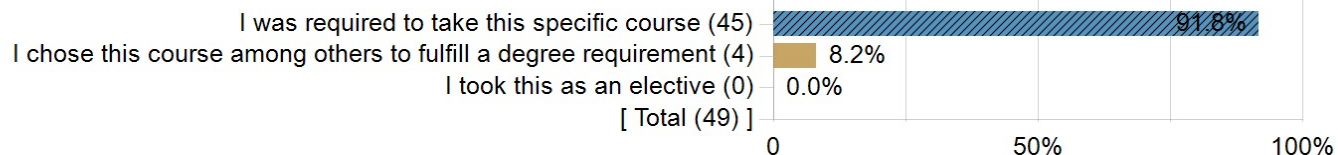
Course evaluations provide snapshots of student perspectives on their course-level learning experiences. Most experts on teaching evaluation advise that no individual method gives the complete picture of an instructor's teaching effectiveness; multiple and diverse measures, on multiple occasions, are advised to give a full picture of the teaching effectiveness of a particular instructor. Moreover, other factors, such as size of class, level of the class, and content of the course, can cause small variations in the ratings. Therefore, student perspectives for a particular instructor or course should be interpreted as a snapshot, and not as providing complete information on the teaching effectiveness of that instructor.

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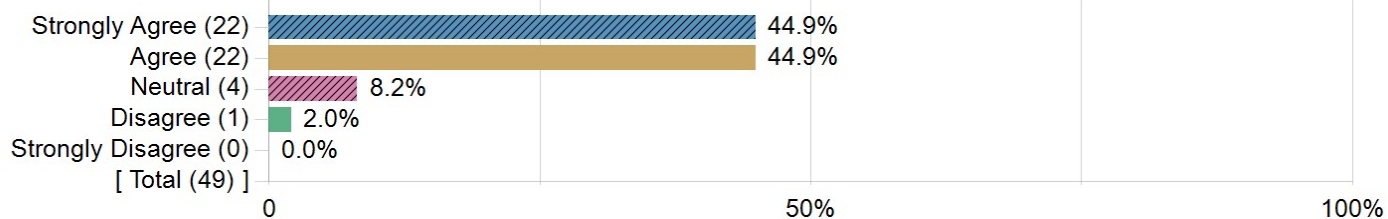
Creation Date: **Friday, May 9, 2025**

## Course Questions

Why did you take this course?

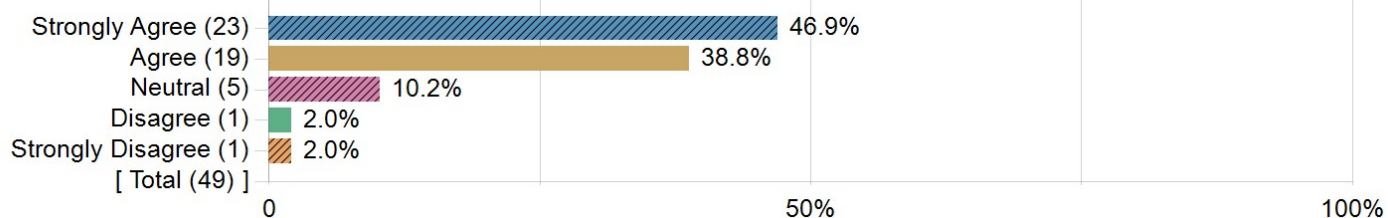


During this course, I gained a deeper understanding of the subject matter.



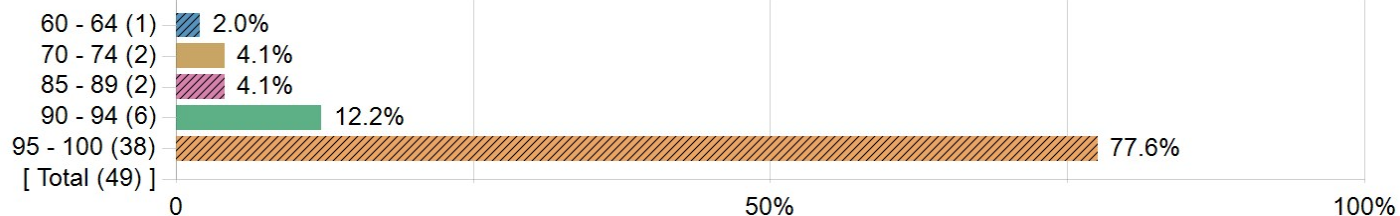
| Statistics | Value |
|------------|-------|
| Mean       | 4.33  |

The course was well organized.



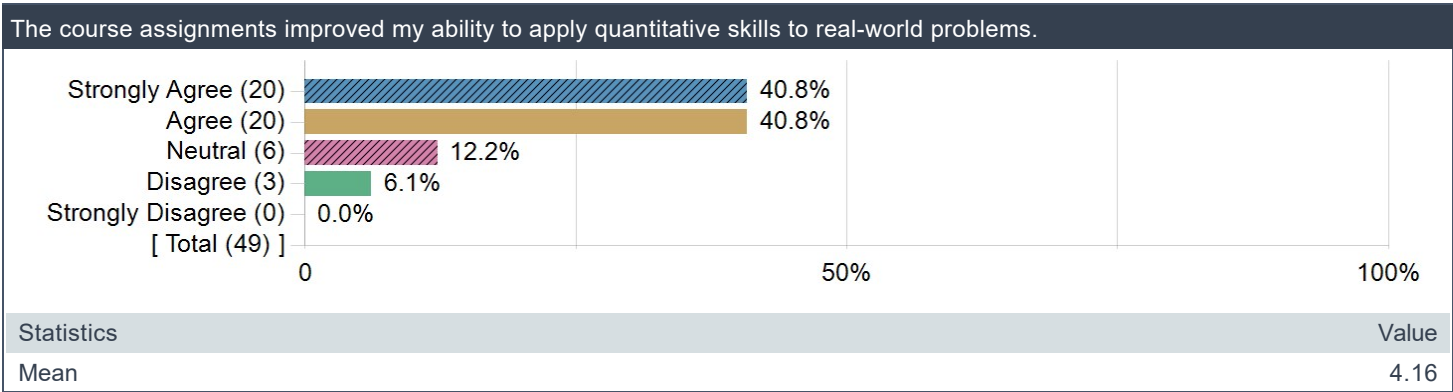
| Statistics | Value |
|------------|-------|
| Mean       | 4.27  |

Overall, approximately what percentage of the course meetings did you attend or complete (online, in person, or asynchronously)?



| Statistics | Value |
|------------|-------|
| Mean       | 95.67 |

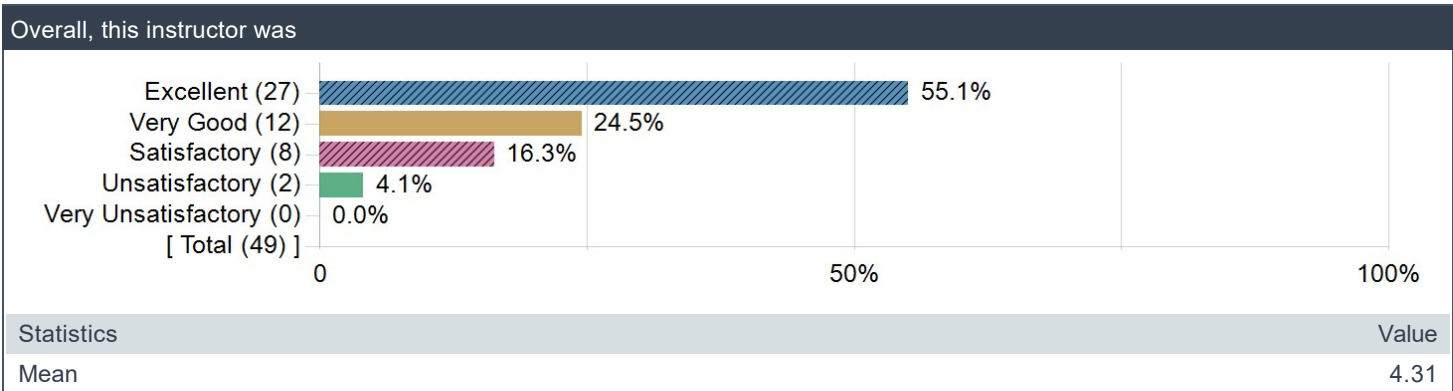
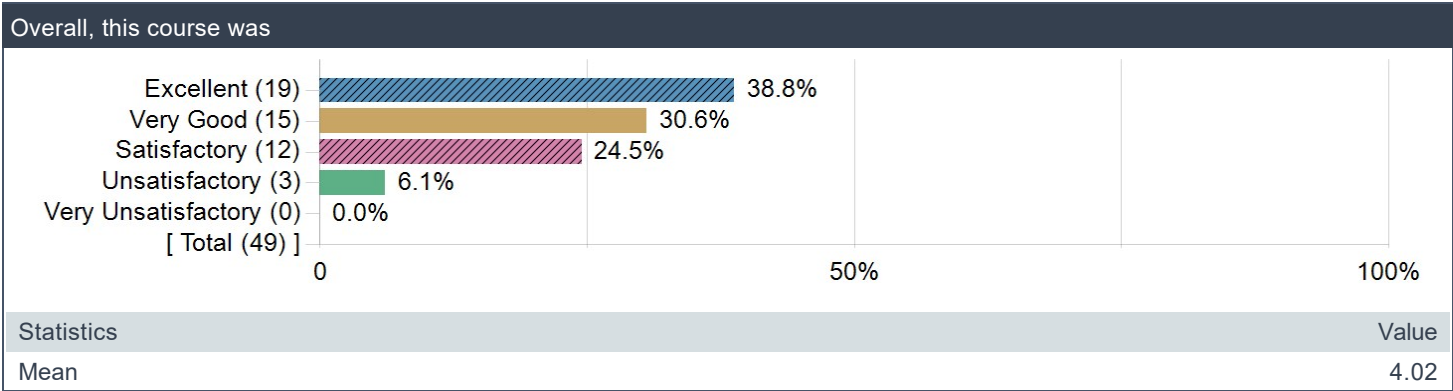
The course assignments improved my ability to apply quantitative skills to real-world problems. (Flag Question)



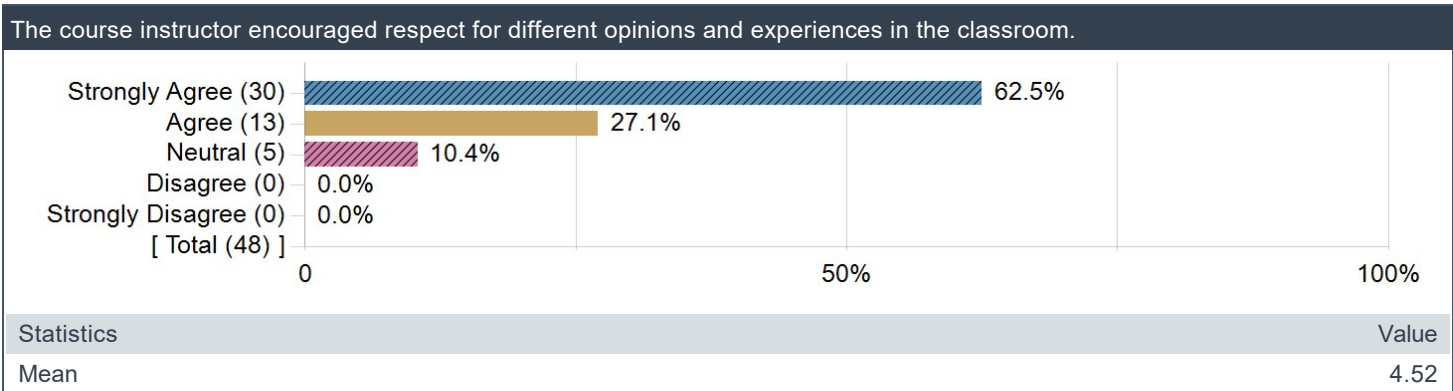
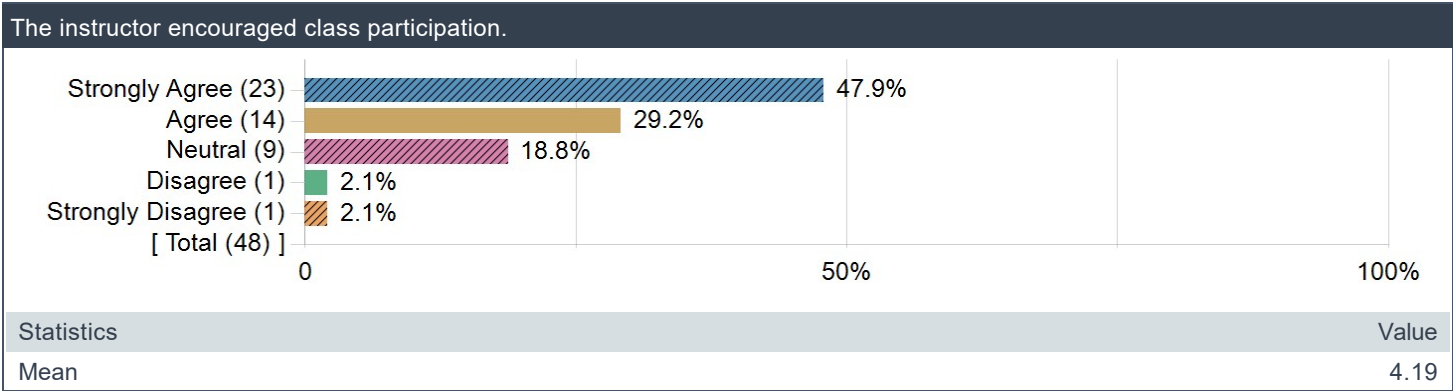
## Instructor Questions

|                                                                                           | Strongly Agree | Agree | Neutral | Disagree | Strongly Disagree | Responded | Mean |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|-------|---------|----------|-------------------|-----------|------|
| The instructor clearly explained the course objectives and expectations.                  | 55.1%          | 36.7% | 8.2%    | 0.0%     | 0.0%              | 49        | 4.47 |
| The instructor fostered an inclusive learning environment.                                | 69.4%          | 22.4% | 6.1%    | 2.0%     | 0.0%              | 49        | 4.59 |
| The instructor effectively explained the concepts and subject matter in this course.      | 57.1%          | 26.5% | 10.2%   | 6.1%     | 0.0%              | 49        | 4.35 |
| The instructional techniques kept me engaged in learning.                                 | 51.0%          | 26.5% | 10.2%   | 8.2%     | 4.1%              | 49        | 4.12 |
| The instructor checked for student understanding of the concepts presented in the course. | 51.0%          | 38.8% | 6.1%    | 2.0%     | 2.0%              | 49        | 4.35 |

Overall Questions



College, School, or Unit Questions



## Comment Questions

Identify aspects of the course that were the most effective in helping your learning.

| Comments                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| GPA factory and review sessions                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| the review sessions                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| Homework                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| the notes and the quizzes                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| The in class quizzes and homework's were helpful to aid my learning and practcie the material                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| Awesome                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| The structured weekly format and clear breakdown of assignments in Canvas helped me stay on track. I also found the use of RStudio and hands-on coding in class to be really effective for learning how to apply statistical concepts in real time. The checkpoint quizzes, while challenging, gave me a great way to regularly check my understanding, and the detailed feedback on homework helped reinforce the material. I also appreciated that the class encouraged collaboration on homework—it helped deepen my understanding through peer discussion. |
| The homeworks were very useful for me to test my knowledge.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| a                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| Professor Bolfarine really communicate concepts clearly and takes the time to help his students. He responds promptly and is proactive.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| The PDF write ups for the material (our textbook)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| The instructor was very thorough and easy to ask for help from.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| homeworks                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| The class being online was helpful and the recorded lectures made reviewing easier.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| TA review sessions were very helpful and straightforward. The homework was also very useful and helped us apply concepts well.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| The professor was extremely helpful during office hours.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| The home works were very helpful as well as the exam reviews recordings and the lectures themselves!                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| sdf                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| The slideshows, in class quizzes, homeworks, and review sessions really helped me apply myself and understand the course materials                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| The practice assignments and the case studies were the most effective in helping me apply and understand the material.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| Being able to go back and review the lectures was the most effective                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| recorded classes                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| I think that the homework was very effective for my learning, as well as the in class quizzes.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| STA 235 is the hands-on approach to statistical learning using real-world data. The combination of RStudio, in-class walkthroughs, and clear step-by-step instruction helped reinforce complex concepts like regression, hypothesis testing, and confidence intervals                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| The professors teaching style.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| Weekly quizzes to test my knowledge were certainly helpful. I think the TA review sessions are where I got the best understanding of course material.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| The TA led sessions.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| Office Hours                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| Very knowledgable of the subject matter and good at showing how to use r studio to make sense of complex data.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| Completing review problems in lecture helped me see the content that had been taught in class be applied. This really helped me better solidify my understanding.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| Office Hours videos                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| examples in class                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| Specific examples that reinforced the content.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| Very nice and helpful professor                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| The homework and practice exams                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| Weekly in class quizzes that directly related to the topics helped my learning.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |

| Comments                                                                                                                                                                             |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Homework's                                                                                                                                                                           |
| The homeworks                                                                                                                                                                        |
| The homeworks were very helpful as well as the TA review sessions were super critical to my understanding of concepts.                                                               |
| office hours and just in class lectures were really helpful                                                                                                                          |
| I think the homeworks were really well made and the questions helped me understand the concepts. Also I liked how the majority of class was doing examples instead of just lecturing |

**Identify the aspect of the course that you found most challenging, why you found it was challenging, and suggest one thing that could be done to help future students meet that challenge more effectively.**

| Comments                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| hard to focus with online format, professor moves really fast so I got behind easily which made it hard                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| the coding.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| N/A                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| the quizzes because they were often hard                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| I found the lectures to be difficult to follow. Most of the time, the professor would just type out the solutions to the problems but not actually teach how to solve them                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| It was long                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| The most challenging aspect of the course was the Mastery Exam format. Despite feeling comfortable with the material during weekly quizzes and homework, the Mastery Exam felt like a big jump in difficulty and time pressure. It was hard to know what level of depth to expect or how to prepare efficiently. To help future students, I think it would be helpful to offer a more detailed review session or a set of guided practice problems that closely mirror the exam format and level of complexity.          |
| Since the course was online, it was difficult to follow class. Maybe do instapolls or something else to promote active participation.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| a                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| The content itself is challenging, bu the course is not. By providing office hours and hosting review sessions, the professors leading STA 235 do a wonderful job of providing resources to help students succeed.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| Nothing really                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| The practice exams and quizzes did not prepare us super well for the exams because the exams were all interpretation while the practice exams and quizzes involved coding.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| logs, just more explaining of them                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| This class is incredibly packed with information. The 2 hour time block makes focusing and comprehending the material extremely difficult. Having someone talk at you for 2 hours straight with no breaks and rushing through material is NOT helpful at all. On top of this, the majority of lectures are spent coding in R and learning how to perform functions in the software, but the exams and quizzes are extremely conceptual and we barely spend anytime in class talking about the theory behind the science. |
| The quizzes at the beginning of classes were made, the class rushed at the end, and I feel like I didn't understand concepts that well when they were rushed.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| I found the content itself extremely challenging.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| The most challenging aspect of the class would be trying to consume a high volume of diverse information after spring break, and retain it/thoroughly learn it as the semester continues moving at a fast pace.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| sdf                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| Sometimes the homework had questions that I didn't remember learning in class so that was pretty confusing.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| The most challenging part was keeping track of complex concepts across lectures. A more detailed summary page after each class could help future students.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| The exams were very separate from the structure of our learning. For example, we were learning with R script and applying what we learned on RStudio. But the exams aren't related to RStudio, so studying and prep are hard.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| in class quizzes                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| I think the tests were hard because I do not like to study.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| The most challenging aspect of STA 235 was learning how to properly interpret the output from RStudio, especially when dealing with regression models. While running, the code was manageable and understanding what the results meant in context took more time and practice.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| I found the application of some of the concepts difficult when they were applied to different contexts.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |



| Comments                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Doing Homeworks in R studio, when we are not actually tested on our coding ability.                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| Trying to stay engaged.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| Course material and having paper exams                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| Sometimes wasn't the best at explaining concepts.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| Overall, I felt that the class was fully conducive to an excellent learning experience.                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| Exams                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| quiz                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| Translating the code based learning from class into more conceptual knowledge was sometimes difficult. More integrated concepts during lessons could help.                                                                                                                                           |
| N/A                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| The quizzes. I wish we could see them afterward, as they are an effective study tool.                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| Course was different as they changed it to a paper test but the assignments still involved coding.                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| Quizzes, they were often beyond to what we covered in class and were too difficult based on what we were prepared for. Quizzes and homework's should better reflect test questions.                                                                                                                  |
| I think we were not properly prepared for the paper exams as the questions asked were different from what we do in class and on quizzes/ homeworks                                                                                                                                                   |
| The aspect of the course that I found most challenging was the exams. They were difficult but with the right preparation I was able to manage.                                                                                                                                                       |
| The quizzes were really difficult                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| I understand why we have the quizzes at the beginning of class but I think that they took up too much class time. Since we only meet once a week I wish we would have had more time to cover the new material, especially in the second half of the semester when the topics started getting harder. |